

Diagonal distance has a test

Chess Math

THE IDEA

Two squares lie on the same diagonal when the absolute file difference equals the absolute rank difference. A bishop can travel between them in one move if no piece blocks the path and the destination is legal.

WORKED EXAMPLE

From b2 to g7, the file difference and rank difference are both five. The route passes through c3, d4, e5, and f6. A single blocker on any of those squares stops the bishop.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Are b2 and g6 on one diagonal?

ANSWER AND REASONING

No. Their coordinate differences are five and four. Visual proximity does not make a bishop attack real. Trace each intervening square when a long diagonal matters.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Equal coordinate differences reveal a diagonal.